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AS INDIAN AUTHORITIES KEEP A STRICT WATCH ON CHINESE INVESTMENTS, TWO CHINESE FOUR-WHEELER MAJORS, MG MOTOR AND BYD, ARE CHANGING TRACK AND PREPARING FOR THE LONG HAUL

BY ARNAB DUTTA

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IN MAY 2019, Rajeev Chaba, then President and Managing Director of MG Motor India, was a proud man. He had just overseen the launch of the company's first locally made sports utility vehicle (SUV). In the year and a half that followed, the company sold over 72,000 units, no mean feat for a new entrant.

Little did Chaba know then that four years after its launch with much fanfare, he would have

to scout for a buyer for the company—owned by SAIC Motor Corporation, the largest Chinese state-owned automobile manufacturer—as it looks to 'Indianise' its operations by selling a majority stake to Indian investors. Billionaire industrialist Sajjan Jindal is reported to be interested in acquiring a 48 per cent stake in the company.

But then again, the wheels of commerce often hit speed bumps because of extraneous circumstances. In MG Motors India's case, those circumstances pertained to a clash between Indian and Chinese soldiers in the Galwan Valley in Ladakh in May 2020.

The subsequent chill in relations enveloped all aspects of India-China relations. The Indian govern-

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